

Razor's Edge



Model family

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Structure - Instruments of Constraint



Model family



A family of possible models is chosen before optimization and comparison start. The procedure is subjective and blends objective function values, implementability, philosophy, and preference.



Occams razor, model comparison, parsimony, complexity penalties, AIC, BIC, ELPD, minimum description length,



Balance model expressivity and simplicity, order models on a lattice.



Complexity is real but wrongly discarded because of a parameter count.



Reduce target card to its simplest form. Then reduce further.



"How do you measure and favor simplicity in your model?"



The razor was honed until it split hairs, then atoms, then reasons. Afterwards the razor split itself and no one ever found a use for it thereafter.

